

Neural Networks In Computing

The Perceptron, also known as MARK 1, built by Frank Rosenblatt at Cornell University was a computer that could learn by trial and error, which was also the first time artificial neural networks were used in computing. It was built on an IBM 704.

Robots In Manufacturing

The first robotic manufacturing device was created by Unimation (now Westinghouse). The brainchild of Joe Engelberger and George Devol, the Unimate was used to automate manufacturing TV tubes, and later used in General Motors' automobile factory to handle hot metal parts. It followed instructions stored on a magnetic drum.

1962

Packet Switching Comes In

January: A Programming Language Landmark

APL (A Programming Language) was developed by Ken Iverson. Considered a unique programming language with many eccentricities, it was intended to be a teaching tool for mathematics. Unique features included the lack of any English words as commands, including "if"; use of special characters that were not part of the regular keyboard, like Greek characters; and evaluating expressions from right to left. With unique language notations, APL allowed programs to be written with the fewest possible lines of code.

March: One More Small Computer

The LINC (Laboratory Instrumentation Computer) was created. Designed by Wesley Clark and Charlie Molnar, and assembled by the users themselves after the necessary training in programming and assembly, using modules made by Digital Equipment Corp., it was intended for real-time laboratory data processing. Unlike most computers of its day, the LINC was small enough to be accommodated on a lab table, it also sported a proper keypad, a 256 x 256 CRT display, a graphical user interface, and four knobs that pro-